Transition Guide

What is QuestGuard?

QuestGuard is a gamified tactical tabletop roleplaying game for the younger generation, who are more used to video games and board games, and want a fast, rules-light, combat-focused alternative to the mainstream and older systems: it's the opposite of old-school!

While playing QuestGuard, you will find more "gamified" elements, both for the players and for the Quest Master. There is an emphasis on build variety, combos, and rules to help Quest Masters have an easier time, and depth through interactions, not complexity.

We created QuestGuard out of love for tabletop roleplaying, to fit our needs and, most importantly, to fit with how the current generation actually plays combat RPGs.

If you've played Dungeons & Dragons or Pathfinder, you will find QuestGuard very easy to pick up!

Is this a spin-off?

Nope! QuestGuard is its own game, completely separate from other traditional fantasy roleplaying games!

What to expect?

QuestGuard is systems-light: there is no roll to hit, there are hardly any tables, no concentration, no spell components or spell slot levels, no opportunity attacks, no saving Checks in combat (crowd control/status effect is direct and fair).
There are no long or short rests, as the Quest Master has better control over the pacing through the Adventure and Enemy Worthiness system.
There is are proficiency systems, no stat-to-skill lists, damage reduction from defenses, success degrees, diminishing returns on actions, and the list keeps on going!

Character abilities are gamified for gameplay rather than realism, to be able to do things such as creating gold or magic items out of thin air or farming enemies. Characters can respec between Adventures, all monsters are tactical and change how you must approach combat, and this is just the tip of the iceberg!

Also, QuestGuard a 2d6 game as opposed to d20, and follows a 3-Action-Point system.

How to start?

You're in the right place! You can create a character, quickly and without hassle, using our Hero Creator, going to Create Hero in the website menu. It will take you through everything you need!
Also, our website https://questguardrpg.com features a "Play With Us!" button. Once clicked, it will redirect you to our Discord group, where we regularly host campaigns and one-shot adventures for new and old players alike!

Feel free to say hi and show your Hero!

WHY QUESTGUARD?

It's gamey

Everything in QuestGuard is intended to have a good flow in combat, be simple and allow for awesome Ability combinations.

The complexity and skill expression does not come from number crunching, but rather from how you choose to combo your character pieces together.

Your character build flows and all game elements fit in such a way that they don't hinder one-another. It's clean.



Taketh Away Sight

2 Action Points 1 Mana

CONTROL EFFECT
DAMAGE

Heal or deal 2d12 True Damage to a Unit you can see. It is Blinded and, for 1 Turn, can't see you and can't make ranged Acts.

For Epic Units, only limits their next offensive act to 1 meter Line of Sight.

A Blind Unit's next Damage/Heal Act deals -50% Damage/Healing.

Figure out your own combos and unleash them upon your foes!



Pyromancy

Passive

Only works in Worthy Combat

SCALING

Every Turn, after the first time you deal Damage to 2 or more Enemies with the same Ability, increase all Fire Damage you deal by 1 for the rest of the combat.

This extra Damage is applied as normal extra Damage, before any other calculations.



Burning Breath

0 Action Points 1 Mana

Near you Once / Turn

MASS DAMAGE
COMBO

All Units 3x3 meter area take 1d6 Fire Damage.

Combo: If any affected Unit has a Combo, +50% total Damage (to all Units) and does not trigger the Cooldown.

Every class and build path is different and breaks the rules of the game!
TODO: Another spell here



Stouthearten

Passive

You have +100% Inventory capacity. You can wear an extra layer of Light or Medium armor over (or underneath) your armor. Apply all of its effects as normal.

Unarmored is not an armor. 50% Damage reductions of the same type do not stack

TODO: Add some better reasons

Being a quest master is easy

uestGuard is made to be cool for players, and easy and fun for the Quest Master (the game master). Through rules such as the Adventure, Worthiness, Skills, Quirks, etc, you will find running Quest Guard both enjoyable and easy to manage.

Always online

All the resources are always online. As such, there are frequent patches, balance improvements, content updates, and much, much more!

DICE

QuestGuard is a 2d6 system. Whenever you roll a Check, you roll 2 6-sided dice and add any modifiers to it.

Rolling evens (1-1, 2-2, 3-3, and so on) means getting Plot Points! If it was a success, you gain a Plot Point. Otherwise, the Quest Master gains a Plot Point.

Spend Plot Points to introduce Actually facts to the current situation, whether you're a Quest Master or a player. Here are some examples:
"Actually, the shopkeep did leave a window open..."
"Actually, there is a chandelier I could swing on..."
"Actually, since your Hero has Claustrophobia, they are afraid to take this short route."

Which dice are used

In QuestGuard, we use the standard polyhedral dice: d4, d6, d8, d10, d12 and d20 (although the d20 is rarely used).
Hint: we actually also use d2 and sometimes troll players with a d14 (but it's only sometimes, we promise!)

Combat dice

In combat, there is no rolling to hit. Whenever you attack, you roll for Damage directly - most of the time, what you see is what you get. If you rolled a total of 14 on 3d6, you deal 14 Damage.

By default, there are no critical strikes, but some weapons and Abilities can trigger bonus effects based on the rolls. If it can, it is neatly mentioned in its text box.

Bow

2 Action Points | 3-10 meters
2 Instinct | Pierce
170

2d8 + Instinct
Critical Strike: if you rolled an 8, +1d8 Damage and apply a Combo.

1 Action Point: Shoot another quick arrow for 1d8 Damage that can Critically Strike.

Most of the time, you will deal and take Damage. Be prepared

HERO

Hero creation

Like in most RPG's, a Player Character needs a character sheet. Normally, we do it online, on the website, with a dedicated Hero builder.
You can find it on the website at https://questguardrpg.com under Create Hero.

Of course, if you want to do it on paper, you're free to do so, and you can download the Hero Sheet under Game, Downloads, Hero Sheet (PDF, PNG, or PSD).

The proper process for crating a Hero is explained in-depth at the Hero Creation chapter, after this chapter.

What makes a hero different

A Hero is made up of a Race plus a Class. Each of these has a ton of customization options.

Each Race is different, and you can customize it with 2 Racial Features! Every Level, you get a choice of one out of 3 or more Talents to pick from your Class. Talents are powerful Abilities that shape how your Character plays and fights.

Don't be afraid to try strange combinations! Heroes Characters can freely "respec" between missions, changing all Talent choices and learned Abilities

Progression

There are 10 Levels Players can progress through with their Characters.

Levels are packed with interesting options. Every Level unlocks new Abilities, and every Adventure ends with players getting Quirks!

The recommended way to Level-Up is through milestones or checkpoints set by the Quest Master. If using the Experience system, however, going from Level 1 to Level 10 should not take an eternity, either. QuestGuard intends campaigns to play out spanning a few months at most, but it's all up to you and your group.

Stats

There are 4 Main Stats in QuestGuard: Might, Instinct, Focus, and Presence. The Stat is directly the "modifier". In combat, each Stat affects an aspect of your character.

- Might affects base Health (+3 / point)
- Instinct affects Movement Speed (+0.5 / point)
- Focus affects Initiative (+0.5 / point), and you get +1 Action Point on your first Turn per 1 Initiative.
- Presence affects Health Regen (+2 / point)

Quick Note

You can't actualy have Movement and Initiative in fractions! Round it down: 1.5 is the same as 1, -0.5 is the same as -1.

All Stats also contribute to Checks.

Starting stats

Assign the following 4 numbers throughout your stats as you like:

There should be a nice UI here
TODO

ach way to distribute Stats is perfectly valid - there are builds and variations for any combination. QuestGuard is designed so that there is no objectively best way to do anything.

Plus, don't worry, you get +1 in any Stat every Level!

Skills & substats

There isn't a predetermined list of Skills on your Hero Sheet.

When you want to do something, the Quest Master will simply call out for a “Might Check” or a Presence Check”, for example (2d6).

However, each Hero will have non-combat Skills they can add themselves to the Roll if appropriate.
Each Skill you have explicitly has a bonus (e.g. +3 in Persuasion, +1 in Monstrology, -2 in Control Emotions, etc).

The Quest Master might call for a Presence Roll to ask a quest giver for more reward money, and, if you have a Skill that fits, you can say “I have a +2 in Convincing, can I add it to the roll?”, to which the Quest Master might say yes or no, depending on the situation.

Feel free to invent your own Skills, but you can find a list of recommendations on the website.

The main sense, though, are separate from eachother (e.g. + in Smelling, Sight, Hearing, etc).

Abilities

Almost everything you get in this game is an Ability. Skills, spells, attacks, moves, Feats, Talents, even weapons and armor!

An Ability is simply a rectangle with a clearly defined text, a little colorful icon and tags to help you identify its properties, such as the costs of using it, how often you can use it, the range, etc.



Rime Shackles

1 Action Point 1 Mana

5 meters

DAMAGE
CONTROL EFFECT
COMBO

Deal Cold Damage to a Unit equal to 1d6 + **Its Instinct**.
Slow it and apply a Combo to it.

Combo: Double-Slow it instead!

A Slowed Unit has -50% Movement Speed until its next Movement.

Most of the time, the only thing you need to use an Ability is your hands. No need for materials, a focus, spoken words, etc.

Nifty website trick

On the website, click on the little document icon on the bottom-right of an Ability to copy it to your clipboard. You can then paste it in a Word document, in Paint, Discord, etc.
Your Hero in the Hero Creator online will also display a list of all your Abilities, and you can even use the Ability Sheet Maker tool on the website! TODO add more details.

COMBAT

Combat usually happens on a map, preferably on a grid, and distances are measured in meters. In game, 1 meter is the equivlent of 1 space or 5 feet.

Turn order is clockwise around the table, with monsters somewhere in-between players.

Actions

Each character or monster in combat has 3 Action Points. You can use these Action Points as you like, with no diminishing returns (e.g. you can attack 3 times with a one-handed weapon even).
Abilities that cost 0 Action Points are free and can be done as many times as you like.

Also, on your first Turn in Combat, you gain +1 Action Point for each 1 Initiative you have!



Fire Ball

3 Action Points | 3 Mana

6 meters (to the edge)

Level 6

MASS DAMAGE

All Units in 6x6x6 meter area take 6d8 Fire Damage.

Cover is calculated from the center of the area.

There is no such thing as a "minor-action", "bonus-action", etc.

Flail

1 Action Point | 1 meter

1 Might | Pierce or Smash

150

1d12

Combo: +1d4 Damage

Does not scale with any Stat.

Alternatives: Combat Chains, Kusarigama, Lucerne, Lantern, Anchor

Combo

Many Abilities and weapons “apply a Combo”.
Many Abilities and weapons trigger an extra effect if the target had a Combo! Then the Combo is removed.

Anyone can trigger anyone’s combo. Go make some combos with your team!

Mana

The resource used to cast more powerful Abilities is called Mana. Most Classes use Mana.

You have a number of Mana Points you can use on Abilities.
If you have 5 Mana Points and an Ability requires 2 Mana, you spend 2 Mana and use the Ability. Then, you are left with 3 Mana.

Usually, Mana regenerates in the downtime between Adventures.

Resting & regeneration

There are no rests like short rests or long rests.

You regenerate Health equal to your Health Regen after every Combat. Your Health Regen is defined by your Race.
You regenerate all resources (Health, Mana, Cooldowns, etc) at the end of every Adventure.

Adventures

An Adventure is a time period defined by the Quest Master. It could be a full dungeon, a play session, completing a quest, etc.

An Adventure that makes will have you use everything in your will to survive you will typically contain 3 medium-difficulty combat.

IMPORTANT CONCEPTS

So far so good? Let's discuss some extra things you should know, to get you up to speed.

Turn order

Players may take Turns clockwise (or counter-clockwise) around the table, starting from any player they choose.
Monsters have a stat called Setback that tells them after how many players they can take their Turn.

Initiative

Your Initiative does not affect Turn order, but tells you how many extra Action Points you get on your first Turn in Combat.

Monsters usually don't have Initiative.

Quirks

At the end of every Adventure, each Player Character gets a Quirk, be it positive or negative, based on their performance. These can be phobias, extra Health from being healthy, etc.

We're still testing out Quirks, so the system is not entirely nailed down, but it works!

Balance

The game is balanced mathematically with tables and calculations, so that you may pick any Class and Race combination and have no disadvantage over other players.
Naturally, not everything is perfect, and balance is subject to change. TODO maybe remove this section.

Tools

The website is full of useful tools, such as the Character Creator, Ability Sheet Maker, etc. Make sure you explore and use them!

Premium content

There are menus and pages with a ERROR icon.
This represents Premium Content that will be available only via purchasing it.
The basic rules and content (Basic Set) is fully available and always free, and the game is fully playable with the Basic Set. At the time of writing this book, the Core Set is the first expansion of the game, and requires purchasing.
If you have the TODO book, you automatically own the Core Set! Just make sure you follow the TODO guide to connect your book to your QuestGuard account!

WHAT'S NEXT?

You should build a Hero and show it to us on Discord! We're happy to have you here and play with you and your new Character!

Click on this link to jump straight into the character creation.
Or, if the link doesn't open, go to the Learn To Play section of the website (https://questguardrpg.com), scroll down and click on the Character Creation guide. It will walk you through everything you need to create your first Character!

Feel free to also contact me (Dave) directly over there, I'll gladly talk to you about the game, and answer any question you might have.
You can also find me at davedoubleedev@gmail.com.

Happy adventuring!